cause everything good happens after midnight

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/53298031.

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General Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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by firstitsthespark

Summary

Catra can't sleep, she groans and rolls over to look at her alarm clock.

3:13 am

She sighs and gives in, clicking dial to the one person she knows will also be awake at this hour.

“Catra?” Adora’s voice sounds as if she’s just woken up, but Catra knows better.

“Hey Adora. Want to go for a walk?”

or

Catra and Adora are about to graduate high school, and can't leave things unsaid before they do so

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Catra can't sleep. She is exhausted and it has been hours of trying, but sleep seems to keep evading her no matter what she tries. Her thoughts keep swirling, and she can't seem to calm them down enough to sleep. The end of high school is rapidly approaching and despite all her friends having their plans for the future set in stone Catra still has no clue. They're all going to step into the future without her and leave her behind, stuck in her hometown for the rest of her life. She loves her family, but *god,* she does not want to be stuck with them while everyone she knows is off *living* .

Despite her constant self-deprecating jokes Catra knows her friends won't forget her the moment they graduate, but when she's this sleep-deprived it seems a lot more possible.

Catra wishes she could just shut off her brain.

She groans and rolls over to look at her alarm clock.

3:13 am

She sighs and gives in, clicking dial to the one person she knows will also be awake at this hour.

"Catra?" Adora's voice sounds as if she's just woken up, but Catra knows better.

"Hey Adora. Want to go for a walk?" Catra says, hoping she doesn't sound as on edge as she feels.

"Catra, it's past 3 am, why are you still awake?" Adora says, slightly more alert, but still sounding groggy.

"I could ask you the same thing"

"You woke me because you decided to call me at 3.13 in the morning."

“We both know that’s not true. I’ll be at yours in five.” Catra hangs up before Adora has a chance to dispute her. She knows Adora well enough to know she’ll be ready when she gets there, and Adora knows her well enough that she wouldn’t insist on a walk for no good reason.

The walk to Adora’s is quick, not shocking considering they’ve lived on the same street since they were kids. Catra could do this walk in her sleep, and basically is given how little energy she has in her body at the moment. However, Catra knows her own body as well as she knows Adora and knows that regardless of how little energy she has, she will not be falling asleep anytime soon. The reminder of her tiredness starts the thoughts spinning in her head again as she remembers the reason for her insomnia. Catra picks up the pace, knowing Adora’s company will help calm some of her worries.

She sneaks around the back of Adora’s house and climbs the tree next to her window. She knocks on the window and sees Adora jump and turn to face her. Adora opens up the window and climbs out to join her on the branch.

“How do I scare you every time? I told you I was coming.” Catra laughs, immediately feeling better.

“You’re so quiet!” Adora protests.

“That’s the point of sneaking out, isn't it?”

“Shut up,” Adora says with no malice as they lower themselves to the ground. “Where to tonight?”

“The pier?” Catra responds, as if they ever had any intention of going elsewhere.

“Sounds good.”

The walk down to the pier is quiet, and unsurprisingly they are the only ones out walking at this time.

“Considering how often you sneak out, you’d think your parents would’ve noticed” Catra comments.

“You sneak out too, shouldn’t your parents have noticed?”

“Hey, you’re the one who said I was quiet. You stomp around your room, they must be heavy sleepers.”

“Hey! I do not stomp around my room” Adora says with a lighthearted shove.

“Suuure Adora, you definitely don’t” Catra chuckles.

They reach the pier, only slightly shivering from the cold. The ocean is reasonably still, and it’s a clear night so the moon and stars are visible above them.

They sit side by side at the end of the pier and lie back to look up at the stars, actions they don't even have to think about, engrained into their bones after years of doing just this.

“Can you spot any constellations?” Adora asks.

“Adora, we have been coming down here for years and I have never once learnt a constellation, what makes you think this would have changed in the past week?” Catra laughs softly.

“I'm just trying to make conversation!”

“You know we can just lie here in silence and look at the stars? We don't have to talk to each other.” Catra says, realising it may sound harsh, but knowing Adora will understand her intention. She allows herself a moment to revel in how nice it is to have someone who understands her so completely.

“Okay fine, I suppose we can do that” Adora relents.

Catra sits in the bliss of her finally empty mind as she listens to Adora breathe beside her.

They lie there in comfortable silence staring up at the stars for what feels like minutes and hours at the same time.

“Adora?” Catra asks, breaking the silence.

“Yeah?”

“Do you think we’ll stay friends forever?”

“Of course, Catra, what’re you talking about?” Adora replies rolling to face Catra.

“Well summer ends soon and then you’re moving away for college, and I don't know what I'm doing yet, and I don't know…”

“Catra, we’re gonna be sitting side by side at the end of this pier until we die of old age.” Adora jokes

“You know you’re moving away right?” Catra says, trying to sound nonchalant.

Adora turns to look Catra in the eyes, suddenly serious. “We will do this at whatever pier we end up living by, or on a random bench if we end up living somewhere without a pier, but we’re never not gonna be doing this, okay?”

“You think we’re gonna live together?” Catra smiles.

“I can’t have you knocking on my window if I end up in an apartment building, it would be too difficult. just seems easier for you to knock on my door.”

“Or it could be our door,” Catra says quietly, both hoping Adora heard nothing and she could pretend nothing changed, while

simultaneously wanting everything to change.

“Catra?”

“I...” Catra rolls onto her back so she’s no longer looking at Adora.

“Catra, you know I’ll not be your friend, no matter what right?”

Catra feels her heart break just a little, despite knowing that was not Adora’s intent. She takes a breath and decides she has nothing to lose. “What if I didn’t want to be just friends?”

“Catra, I- “

“I know you don’t feel the same, I just… I wanted you to know, you know, before you leave” Catra rushes to say before Adora has the chance to reject her in some impossibly sweet way that would hurt Catra that much more.

“Catra, look at me,” Adora says, still staring at the side of Catra’s face. “Please?”

Catra takes a moment, continuing to not look at Adora, then rolls to face her and is surprised to see an expression in Adora's eyes she’d never seen before, it held a softness that she had only caught glimpses of before.

“I love you,” Adora says.

“I love you too, you’re my best friend.” Catra says, trying to rush along this rejection so Adora won’t see how badly it hurts her. As much as she loves Adora, she doesn’t think she could handle lying on the pier with their sides pressed up against each other, knowing the other girl doesn’t feel the same. It’s an emotion best dealt with alone.

“No, I *love* you. I’ve always loved you.” Adora bites her lip, her go-to habit when she’s nervous.

“Oh. *Oh.* ” Catra lies there for a moment, taking it in. “I-I love you too.”

“Why did you never tell me?”

“I could ask you the same thing” Catra retorts, trying to ease back into the familiarity of their friendship, rather than the unstable territory she had plunged them into.

“Catra, I- “

“I just never wanted to say anything cause then everything would change, but it’s changing anyway, and I just- “ Catra is cut off as Adora leans in and kisses her.

Despite picturing this moment for years it’s nothing like she anticipated, Adora's lips are warm, and she feels heat growing inside her despite the cold surrounding them.

Adora pulls back first, looking at Catra with so much warmth in her eyes that Catra is sure Adora can see mirrored in hers.

“You loooove me,” Adora says, poking Catra in the cheek.

“Shut up,” Catra says, shoving Adora off, but unable to keep the smile off her face. She was such a sap.

“No,” Adora says kissing Catra on the cheek and putting her arm around her.

Catra rolls her eyes, but cuddles into Adora's side.

They stay lying on the pier curled up together until the sky starts to lighten.

“I know we are about to move out, but I think my mum would still kill me if she found out I’d snuck out,” Catra says, hating that the moment has to end.

“Mine too” Adora sighs, she looks down at Catra, “You know you could always come to college with me?”

“Adora, you know I don’t want to go to college, I don’t know what I wanna do.” Catra says, wishing that she didn’t have to turn down moving away with Adora.

“I know, I'm not saying that... I'm just saying…” Adora pauses, looking down nervously.

“What?” Catra asks, her curiosity now piqued.

“You could move in with me. You don’t have to go to college, you could get a job somewhere, or not, we’d probably share a room so it’s not like rent would be hugely increased if we were living together, so I could cover you while you find what you want to do.” Adora rambles as Catra sits frozen. “You don’t have to! I just... I can’t imagine not having you nearby, but if that's too-”

This time Catra kisses Adora cutting her off.

“You doof, of course, I’ll move in with you” Catra smiles “I can’t believe you thought you could leave me that easily.”

“Are you sure? Cause I need you to know that if you don’t want to, I wouldn’t care…. well, I would care, but I won’t be offended” Adora says.

“You need to stop worrying Adora” Catra laughs, “We’ve basically spent all our time together since we met anyway, what’s the difference in sharing a house instead of a street.”

“You mean it?” Adora looks at Catra nervously.

“Adora, I have known you for as long as I can remember.” Catra says in a deeply serious tone, resulting in a look of concern on Adora’s face “I think I can handle sharing a bathroom with you.”

Adora laughs, shattering the tension. “You’re an idiot.”

“You love me.” Catra mocks

“Yeah, I do.” Adora says softly

They lie there for a few more moments.

“We do actually have to get up now though,” Catra says.

Catra and Adora walk home hand in hand, giggling like little kids with their first crush, which they basically were. Though the two of them hadn’t admitted to each other yet quite how early their feelings for each other had started.

Catra drops Adora at her driveway and kisses her, not believing her luck that she can just do that now. Adora kisses back with a passion and Catra thinks she could spend the rest of her days doing just this. Catra pushes up against Adora, causing Adora to stumble back and laugh, not breaking contact with Catra’s lips as they set off the motion sensor lights.

“Adora that better not be you coming home!” Adora’s mum yells out from inside, causing the two girls to jump apart.

“Shit, I thought we were early enough” Adora mutters.

“I hope she doesn’t kill you, cause I want to do that again” Catra says.

“Oh, we are doing that again, she can try and stop me” Adora pulls Catra back in for a quick kiss, and then shoves her off. “Now get out of here before my mum sees you.”

“She already knows we were out together, I bet you she’s already called my mum, who will be waiting for me when I get home”

Catra retorts.

“That’s true, but I better go face her or I may actually never move out.” Adora sighs

“That would be a tragedy, I have a lot of great plans for what we can do once we’re sharing a bed” Catra says with a wink.

“Oh my god, I can’t believe I love you”

“But you do,” Catra tries to say mockingly, but it comes out incredibly soft, “Now go inside you idiot.”

Adora laughs before running to her front door, turning to wave back at Catra before closing the door behind her.

Catra leaves Adora’s house laughing, and she thinks, maybe they’ll be okay.

End Notes

i hope you like it, please be nice, this is my first time writing adora and catra. but let me know your thoughts please! i'd love feedback as long as it's actually constructive

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